UNIVERSITY OF THE PEOPLE

Syllabus for Professional Communication

Credits: 3
COM 2001

Instructor Contact Information:

You can always send your instructor a private message through the Brightspace Messaging system, accessible via the envelope (Messages) icon in the top navigation bar. Once logged into your course, click your instructor's profile page to see all the ways you can communicate with them, including their email address.

Course Description

This course introduces students to the principles and practices of professional communication. Students will learn how to communicate effectively in a variety of professional settings, including written communication, oral communication, and interpersonal communication. They will also learn about the ethical dimensions of professional communication.

Learning Objectives

Institutional Learning Outcomes:

Students will be able to demonstrate the use of clear, well-organized arguments and credible supporting evidence in a logical and organized manner; and execute proper delivery technique to convey a clear message.

Course Learning Outcomes:

1. Identify the key elements of effective professional communication.
2. Apply the principles of effective written communication to a variety of workplace documents, such as emails, reports, and proposals.
3. Use effective verbal communication techniques to deliver clear and concise oral presentations.
4. Use technology effectively to communicate in the workplace.
5. Explain the ethical dimensions of professional communication.
6. Define interpersonal communication strategies for effective communication.

Co/Prerequisites

UNIV 1001 or UNIV 3001

Course Materials

UoPeople courses use open educational resources (OER) and other materials specifically donated to the University with free permissions for educational use. Therefore, students are not required to purchase any

textbooks or sign up for any websites that have a cost associated with them. This course does not have a primary textbook. All required readings and resources will be provided in the weekly Learning Guide.

Technology Requirements

To fully engage in this course and make the most of your learning,

- **PC Required**: A PC is recommended to ensure full compatibility with course tools and activities.
- **Internet Connection**: A stable internet connection is advised for seamless access to course materials and activities.
- **Browser**: For optimal performance and compatibility with course tools, please use an up-to-date browser.

Students must also have the ability to save documents and files. Typically, University of the People learning materials are provided to students in either Adobe PDF or Microsoft Office compatible formats. Therefore, students need to be able to open and save documents in these formats as well.

Campus Tech Support Email for English programs: support@uopeople.edu

Exam Technical Requirements & Support

To ensure maximum compatibility and reliability, it is highly recommended that you use the most recent version of Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox when taking your exam. Furthermore, you should test the computer and browser ahead of time and ensure it has no technical issues that might hinder you during the exam period.

If you experience a technical problem during the exam, please contact your instructor immediately.

Regular and Substantive Interaction

As your instructor, they will interact and engage with each of you on a regular basis throughout the term to support your learning. They will provide direct instruction related to the course's learning objectives, respond to your questions, grade and/or provide feedback on your submitted coursework, post regular announcements, and engage in the course discussion areas regarding academic course content when appropriate.

Course Expectations and Learning Activities

Discussions

Some units in this course require that you complete a Discussion Assignment. You are required to develop and post a substantive response to the Discussion Assignment in the Discussion Forum. A substantive response is one that fully answers the question that has been posted by the instructor. In addition, you must extend the discussion by responding to at least two (2) of your peers' postings in the Discussion Forum. Your discussion posts will be assessed by your instructor. Discussion Forums are only active for each current and relevant learning week, so it is not possible to contribute to the forum once the learning week has come to an end. Failure to participate in the Discussion Assignment by posting in the Discussion Forum and responding to peers as required may result in failure of the course.

Assignment Activities

The assignment activities are graded by your instructor. The grading rubric is listed under the assignment instructions. The grading rubric is a document that outlines the criteria that your instructor will use to

grade your work. You are encouraged to read the assignment rubric before starting the assignment so you can begin with the end in mind.

Quizzes

This course will contain three types of quizzes – the Self-Quiz, the Graded Quiz, and the Review Quiz. These quizzes may contain multiple choice, true/false, or short answer questions. The results of the Self-Quiz will not count towards your final grade. However, it is highly recommended that you complete the Self-Quiz to ensure that you have adequately understood the course materials. Along with the Reading Assignments, the results of the Self-Quiz should be used as part of an iterative learning process, to thoroughly cover and test your understanding of course material. You should use the results of your Self-Quiz as a guide to go back and review relevant sections of the Reading Assignments. Likewise, the Review Quiz will not count towards your final grade but should also be used to assist you in a comprehensive review and full understanding of all course material, in preparation for your Final Exam. Lastly, the results of the Graded Quiz will count towards your final grade. Specific instructions on the format and content of the Graded Quiz will be provided by your instructor.

Learning Activities

The Learning Activities provide practice questions to help you review and reinforce key concepts covered in the course. While they do not count toward your final grade, they are an important part of your learning process and are strongly recommended to help you prepare for graded assessments.

Final Exam

The Final Exam will be available for students to complete between Thursday and Sunday of Week/Unit 9, following the completion of eight units of work. The format of the Final Exam is similar to that of the quizzes and may contain a combination of different question types. You will have one attempt to take the exam, and it will be graded electronically. Specific instructions on how to prepare for and take the exam will be provided during Week/Unit 8.

Course Forum

The Course Forum is the place to raise issues and questions relating to the course. It is regularly monitored by the instructors and is a good place to meet fellow students taking the same course. While it is not required to participate in the Course Forum, it is highly recommended.

Class Introductions

This section is your opportunity to introduce yourself to your classmates and create a vibrant learning community. By sharing your background, interests, and goals, you can create meaningful connections and discover commonalities with your peers.

Participation Expectations

- Be involved and active in your courses.
- Be highly motivated and disciplined.
- Check the course homepage, calendar, and assignment page, the course syllabus, your UoPeople email, and the course discussion forums several times a week.
- Post the required comments and responses to the discussion forum for your course.
- Keep up with your assignments and online quizzes/exams (as applicable) and manage your time well. These quizzes test your knowledge and comprehension of the new content.
- Participate actively in class discussions.

- Be polite and respectful.
- Use proper grammar and correct spelling.
- Be honest and original. Plagiarism will not be tolerated in any online course.

Non-participation is characterized by lack of any assignment submissions, inadequate contributions to the Discussion Forums, and/or lack of peer feedback to Discussion/Written Assignments. Also, please note the following important points about course participation:

- Assignments must be submitted on or before the specified deadline. A course timeline is provided in the course schedule, and the instructor will specify deadlines for each assignment.
- Occasionally there may be a legitimate reason for submitting an assignment late. Most of the time, late assignments will not be accepted and there will be no make-up assignments.
- All students are obligated to inform their instructor in advance of any known absences which may result in their non-participation.

Feedback and Suggestions

We value your input and would encourage you to complete the end of course survey to provide us with course feedback and suggestions, and report issues

Evaluation and Grading Scale

Grading Weights:

Category	% Of Grade	Grade Items (Learning Activities)	Associated Learning Objectives/Outcomes
Discussions	40%	1. Discussion Forum – Unit 1 2. Discussion Forum – Unit 2 3. Discussion Forum – Unit 5 4. Discussion Forum – Unit 6 5. Discussion Forum – Unit 7 6. Discussion Forum – Unit 8	• CLO1 • CLO1 • CLO3, CLO6 • CLO3, CLO6 • CLO4, CLO6 • CLO5, CLO6
Assignment Activities	40%	1. Assignment Activity – Unit 1 2. Assignment Activity – Unit 2 3. Assignment Activity – Unit 3 4. Assignment Activity – Unit 4 5. Assignment Activity – Unit 5 6. Assignment Activity – Unit 6 7. Assignment Activity – Unit 7	• CLO1 • CLO6 • CLO2 • CLO2 • CLO3, CLO4 • CLO3, CLO4, CLO6 • CLO5
Graded Quiz	10%	1. Graded Quiz – Unit 4	• CLO1, CLO2, CLO6
Final Exam	10%	1. Final Exam – Unit 9	• CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO4, CLO5, CLO6
TOTAL	**100%**		

Grading Scale:

Letter Grade	% Grade	Grade Points
A+	98%-100%	4.00
A	93-97%	4.00
A-	90%-92%	3.67
B+	88%-89%	3.33
B	83%-87%	3.00
B-	80%-82%	2.67
C+	78%-79%	2.33
C	73%-77%	2.00
C-	70%-72%	1.67
D+	68-69%	1.33
D	63%-67%	1.00
D-	60%-62%	0.67
F	<60	0.00
W	N/A	N/A

Students may also be granted Withdrawal (W), if they withdraw from the course, or an Incomplete (I) should their circumstances permit. A student who feels they were graded unfairly, or who seeks to dispute a grade, may initiate a grade appeal process. Refer to University Policies for more information on withdrawals and appeals.

Course Schedule

UNIT 1: Introduction to Professional Communication

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.
- Learning Activity completion.

UNIT 2: Effective Professional Communication

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.
- Learning Activity completion.

UNIT 3: Written Communication in the Workplace 1

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.
- Learning Activity completion.

UNIT 4: Written Communication in the Workplace 2

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Learning Activity completion.
- Graded Quiz submission due by Wednesday.

UNIT 5: Verbal Communications Techniques 1

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 6: Verbal Communications Techniques 2

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 7: Technology and Ethical Dimensions of Communication

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 8: Interpersonal Communication

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 9: Final Exam

- Final Exam due by Sunday.

University Policies & Processes

Late Work/Make-up Policy

Please review the Late Work policy in the University Catalog.

Code of Conduct

University of the People expects that students conduct themselves in a respectful, collaborative, and honest manner at all times. Harassment, threatening behavior, or deliberate embarrassment of others will not be permitted. Any conduct that interferes with the quality of the educational experience is not allowed and may result in disciplinary action, such as course failure, probation, suspension, or dismissal. For more information on this topic, please review the General Code of Conduct in the University Catalog.

Procedures for Resolving Academic Grievances/Appeals

If you believe that the final grade you received for a course is erroneous, unjust, or unfair, please contact your course instructor. This must be done within fourteen days of the last day of the term. For more information on this topic, please review the Grievance Policy and Grade Appeals Procedure in the University Catalog.

Withdrawal and Drop Date Policy

Please review the Course Drops and Withdrawals policy of the University Catalog.

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Please review the Code of Academic Integrity in the University catalog.

Intellectual Property

UoPeople respects the intellectual property rights of others who seek to create, preserve, and disseminate knowledge through teaching, collective learning, and continued research at the University at large. For more information on this topic, please review the Intellectual Property policy in the University catalog.

Reasonable Accommodations

Contact your Program Advisor to open a request for support.

Student Support Services & Resources

English Programs

Academic Advising: advising@uopeople.edu
Financial Aid: financial.aid@uopeople.edu
Library Resources: library@uopeople.edu
Payment Processing: payments@uopeople.edu
Student Services: student.services@uopeople.edu
Technical Support: support@uopeople.edu